

Res Zoom, even 10x shots are shockingly usable. Beyond zooming, it's also a great portrait tool for compressing backgrounds beautifully and producing DSLR-like bokeh. Portrait mode itself has become surgical, cutting hair and glasses with precision.

What's remarkable is how much of the Pixel 10 Pro XL's imaging DNA translates seamlessly into the Fold. There's a new AI-powered trick up its sleeve: Low Light Boost for Instagram, which automatically enhances story videos shot in dim environments and could be genuinely useful for creators. The new Camera Coach guides your framing without being patronising. Add Me remains one of those small but genuinely useful tools that make sense only on a foldable, now aided by Dual Screen Preview so everyone in the frame can see themselves while you compose.

Google's C2PA Content Credentials integration adds a quiet but important layer of authenticity, allowing verifiable metadata for photos.

The overall imaging package doesn't feel radically new, but it feels deeply refined. No matter which lens you choose, you can point, shoot, and trust the result.

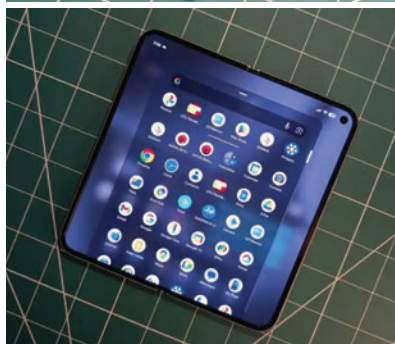
PERFORMANCE & SOFTWARE

Tensor chips have always been a double-edged sword, brilliant at AI, inconsistent at efficiency. The Tensor G5 changes that narrative. Built on a new architecture with a better thermal envelope, it delivers performance that's finally competitive but still trails behind the raw performance metrics of the Qualcomm's or Mediatek's flagships.

Compared to last year's Pixel 9 Pro Fold, the gains are significant:

- AnTuTu: 1,329,051 vs 1,089,915
- Geekbench Single / Multi: 2252 / 6068 vs 1782 / 3793
- 3DMark Wildlife Extreme: 3182 vs 2559
- PCMark: 15,779 vs 13,275

The CPU throttling test shows sustained 91% performance which is a huge leap over the previous generation. Apps launch faster, multitasking feels imme-



diately, and sustained workloads like photo editing or using dual-screen productivity apps no longer cause thermal discomfort. Even under 3DMark's stress runs, surface temperatures stay manageable with cooling improvements and refined SoC design.

But the real leap lies in the experience. Magic Cue is an anticipatory assistant, surfacing relevant info during calls or chats without being intrusive. And Gemini let's you point the camera at an object, ask it a question or share your screen for context-based help. Combined with Pixel Journal, Pixel Studio (now powered by Imagen 4), and Smart Edit in Gboard, the Fold becomes a personal workspace that feels integrated rather than feature-bloated.

Seven years of OS and security updates further anchor it in longevity, something no other foldable promises today.

BATTERY LIFE

The Pixel 10 Pro Fold packs a 5015mAh battery, modest on paper, yet effective in practice. Thanks to Tensor G5's improved efficiency and better display power management, the phone clocked 15 hours and 49 minutes in PCMark's

Battery Life test, which is a huge generational leap over the Pixel 9 Pro Fold.

Real-world endurance easily stretches beyond a full day of mixed use, even with the inner display in regular rotation. Foldables traditionally suffer from split-use inefficiency, but this one feels more consistent, less of that sudden drop-off when switching from outer to inner screens.

Charging remains moderate rather than groundbreaking: 0–100% in 1 hour 30 minutes, with 70% achieved in 46 minutes. The addition of 15W Qi2 Pixelsnap wireless charging, though, makes everyday top-ups feel more fluid, especially with the new magnetic stand.

VERDICT

The Pixel 10 Pro Fold isn't revolutionary. But it's a foldable that no longer needs to justify its existence. It just works beautifully. The displays are brighter, the hinge sturdier, the cameras more mature, and the Tensor G5 finally lives up to its name with efficiency gains and improved endurance.

Sure, it's still expensive, and its crease hasn't vanished. The design remains more understated than flashy, and Google's approach to charging still lags behind the fastest in the business. But those aren't dealbreakers, they're trade-offs made for balance. At its core, it's about refinement over reinvention.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Google Tensor G5 | Security: Titan M2 security coprocessor | RAM: 16 GB | Storage: 256 GB | Display (Outer): 6.4-inch (162 mm) Actua display | Display (Inner): 8-inch (204 mm) Super Actua Flex display | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Cameras (Rear): 48MP Main + 10.5MP Ultrawide + 10.8MP 5x Telephoto | Camera (Front): 10MP Dual PD | Camera (Inner): 10MP Dual PD | Battery: 5015 mAh | Charging: 30W Wired and 15W wireless | IP Rating: IP68

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